STAFF GUIDE · AJG (ASSEMBLYMEMBER JESSE GABRIEL) PRESS COVERAGE

Updating the tracker with the Update station

How to find new stories about Jesse Gabriel and save them into the PC tracker, from start to finish.

How the job works

New stories reach the tracker in a loop between your PC and a page on claude.ai called the **Update station**. The PC tells the station what the tracker already has; the station searches for what is new and hands back one zip file; the PC checks it and saves it. The station has its own Step 1, Step 2 and Step 3; this guide uses those names, and names the PC parts by where they are.

Part	Where	What happens	Page
Make the “for Update” file	PC tracker	A small file listing the stories the tracker already has. Make a new one after every save.	4
Move the file to the station’s computer	Office PC and another computer	Office PCs can’t open the Update station yet, so the file goes by USB stick or OneDrive to a computer that can.	3
Step 1: load the file	Update station	The station reads what the tracker already has, and works out from which date to search.	5
Step 2: Update	Update station	Searches the web for new stories. About 25 minutes.	8
Also: add PDFs (optional)	Update station	NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, for stories the web search can’t reach. (For NewsBank, see the separate NewsBank Download Guide.)	11
Step 3: download the update folder	Update station	One .zip file with everything found. Move it back to the office PC.	12
Bring in update and Save	PC tracker	The tracker shows what it would change; you press Save.	13
Make refresh files	PC tracker	So your colleagues’ copies match yours.	17

Words used in this guide

Word	What it means
Claude	The AI assistant (made by Anthropic) that reads each search result, keeps the real stories and rates them.
TinyFish	The web-search service the station uses to find new stories.
“for Update” file	A small file the PC tracker makes that lists the stories it already has. It holds no article text.
Update folder	The .zip file the station gives you. (A .zip is one file that holds many files.)
Update station	A page on claude.ai that does the searching. It has three steps, called Step 1, Step 2 and Step 3 on the page.
Refresh file	A .zip the keeper makes after a save, so colleagues’ copies match.
Keeper	The one person who saves updates (currently Sammy).
Fingerprint	A short code worked out from the workbook’s exact contents, like `41315fe0`. It changes whenever the workbook changes.

Before you start

1. **Use the keeper copy** of the PC tracker. Only the keeper saves updates. (The companion guide, *Using the AJG Press Tracker*, explains keeper and reader copies.)
2. **Close Excel** if the workbook is open.
3. **Find a computer that can open the Update station.** Office PCs can't open it yet (see the box below). Use another computer, for example a Mac, and sign in to claude.ai there with the office account (ask the keeper).
4. **Have the Update station link ready:**

   Open the Update station

   https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL
5. **The first time, allow Claude and TinyFish for the station page.** Claude: in the page's Permissions menu, allow it, including sending pictures (it reads newspaper pages). TinyFish: it must be connected in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors) and allowed for the page.

OFFICE PCS CAN'T OPEN THE UPDATE STATION YET

The station is a page on claude.ai, and the office network blocks the address that these pages run from (`*.claudeusercontent.com`). IT has been asked to allow it. Until it does, do the station part on a computer that is not on the office network, and carry the files by USB stick or OneDrive:

1. On the office PC, make the "for Update" file (next page).
2. Copy it to the other computer.
3. Run the station there (Steps 1 to 3) and download the update folder.
4. Copy the update folder (the .zip) back to the office PC. Bring it in and save it there.

The tracker itself and the workbook stay on the office PC. Once IT allows the address, you can do it all on the office PC.

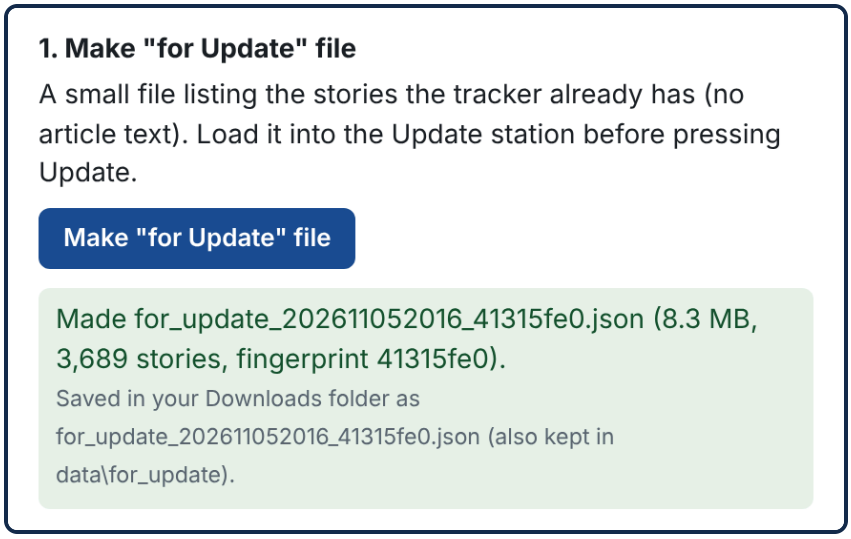
Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC

The Update station never changes your workbook. It only makes a zip file. The PC tracker shows you everything in the zip before it saves, and backs up the workbook first.

ON THE PC

Make the “for Update” file

1. Start the tracker (double-click `Start Tracker.cmd`).
2. Click **Tracker files** at the top right.
3. Under **1. Make “for Update” file**, click the button. It takes about a minute.
4. The file downloads to your Downloads folder, named like `for_update_202611052016_41315fe0.json`: the date and time it was made, then the workbook’s fingerprint.
5. If the station will run on another computer, copy this file to it (USB stick or OneDrive).



The file was made and downloaded.

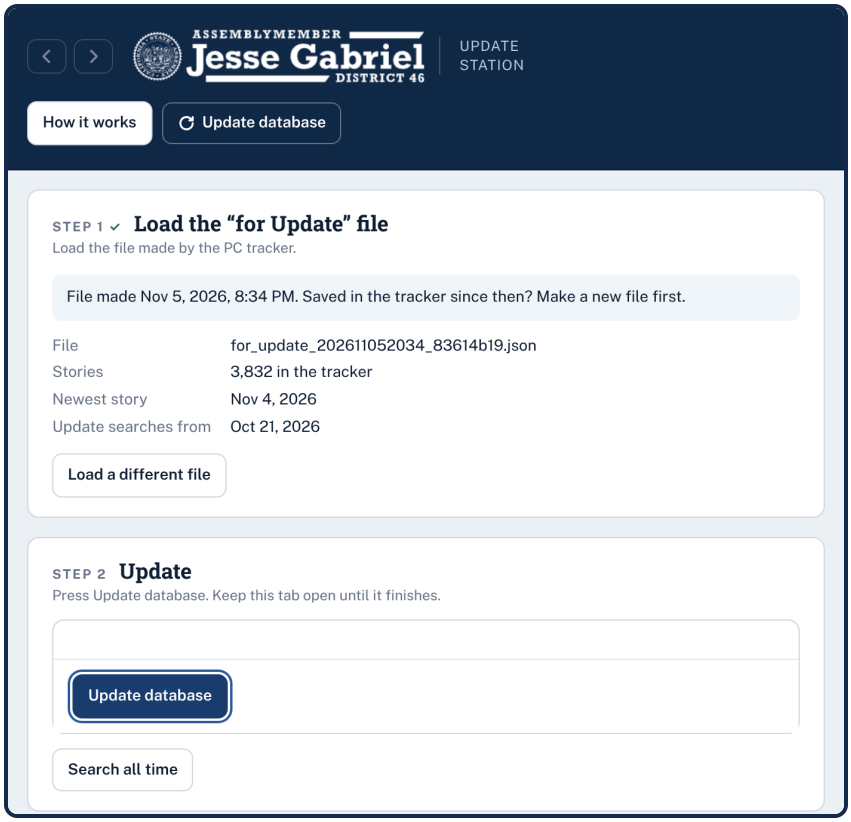
MAKE A NEW ONE AFTER EVERY SAVE

The file lists the stories the tracker has right now. A file made before a save doesn’t know about the stories that save added, so the station would find them again. The file is not stored online.

IN THE STATION · STEP 1

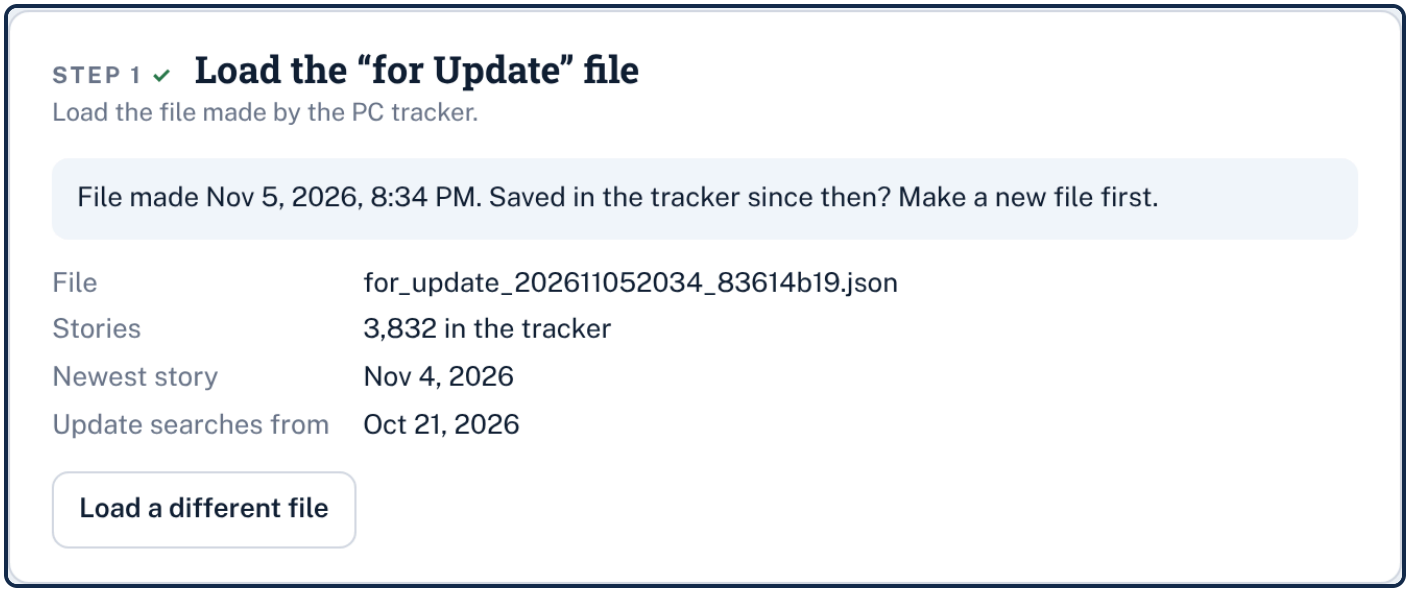
Open the station and load the file

1. Open the Update station in your browser: https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL. If it asks you to sign in, sign in to claude.ai with the office account (ask the keeper).
2. In **Step 1**, drop the “for Update” file on the dashed box, or click the box and choose the file.
3. Check what the station read from it (next page).



The station after the file is loaded. Step 1 is done (the green check mark), Step 2 is ready. The NewsBank and ProQuest boxes are below.

What Step 1 shows



Step 1 after loading the file.

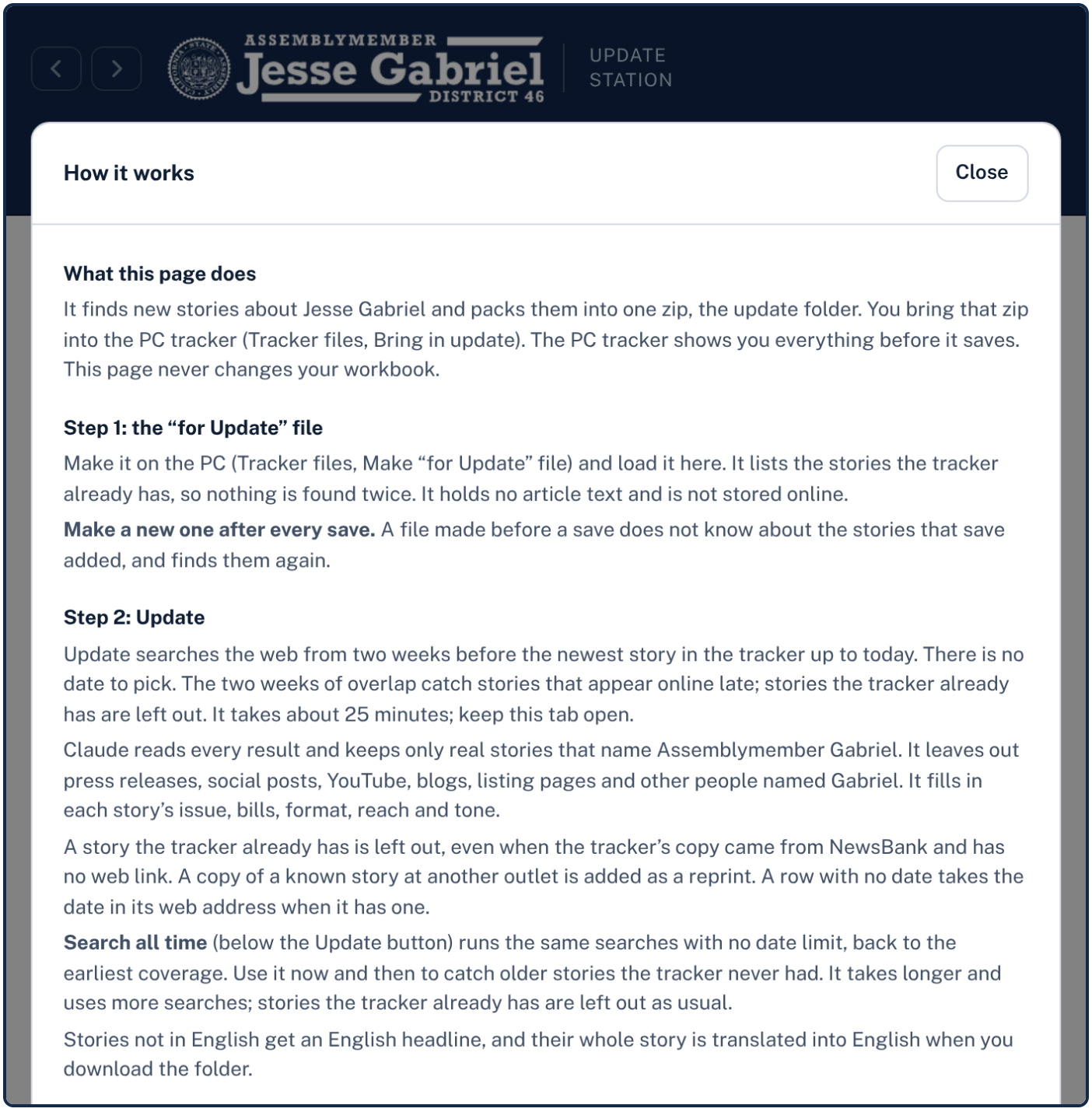
- **The gray line** says when the file was made: “Saved in the tracker since then? Make a new file first.” If you saved after making the file, stop and make a new “for Update” file.
- **Stories** is how many stories the tracker has.
- **Newest story** is the date of the newest story in the tracker.
- **Update searches from** is two weeks before that date. **There is no date to pick.** The station works it out. The two weeks of overlap catch stories that reach the web late. Stories the tracker already has are left out.

The top of the station has two buttons. **How it works** opens the station’s own short explanation. **Update database** starts the search, the same as the button in Step 2.



The top of the station: How it works (left) and Update database (right).

How it works



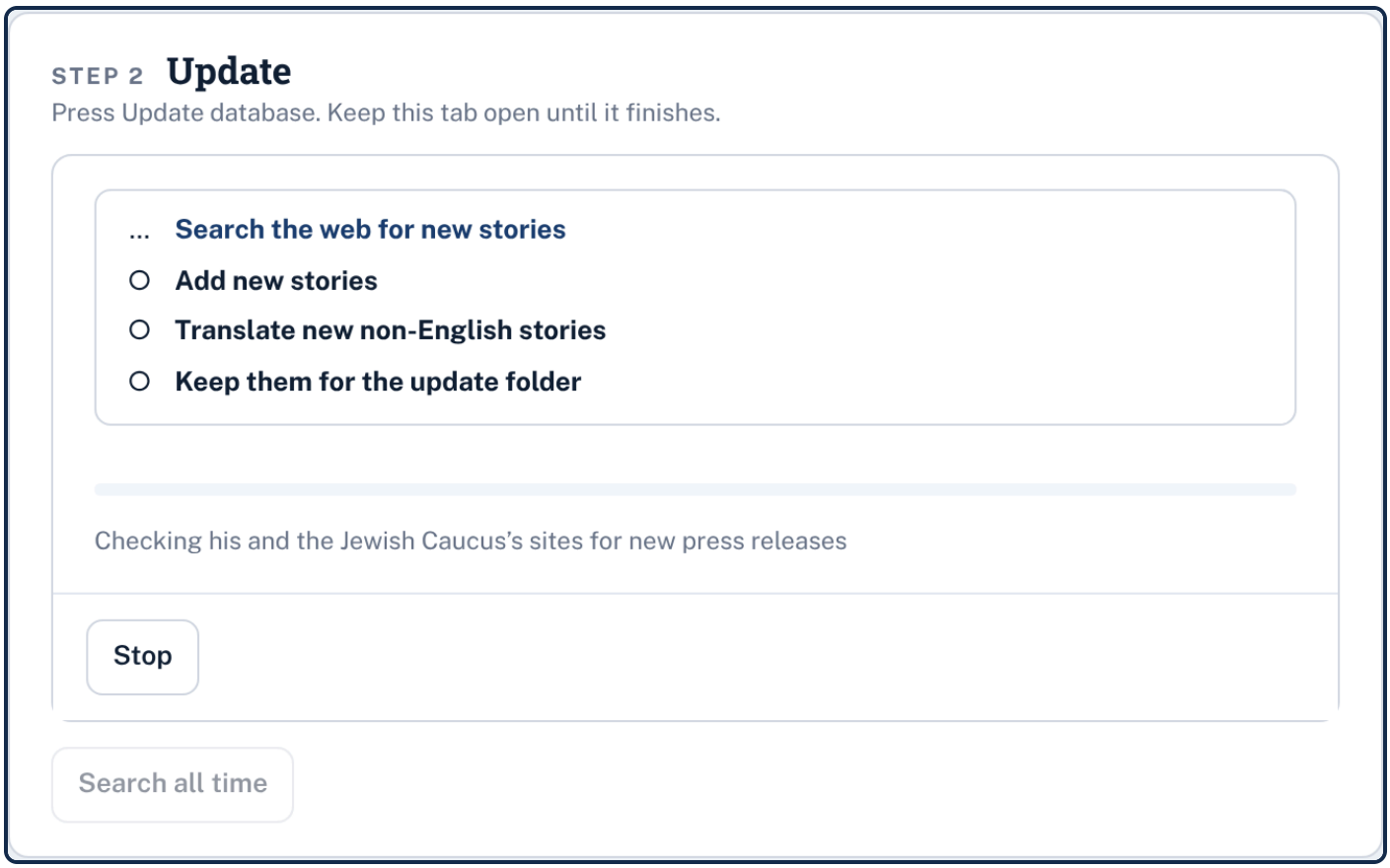
The top of the How it works window. It goes on to cover NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, downloading, Automatic mode and what to do if something is blocked. Close returns to the page.

Step 2 of the page itself shows only the buttons, the progress and the results. Everything that explains what the search does is in this window.

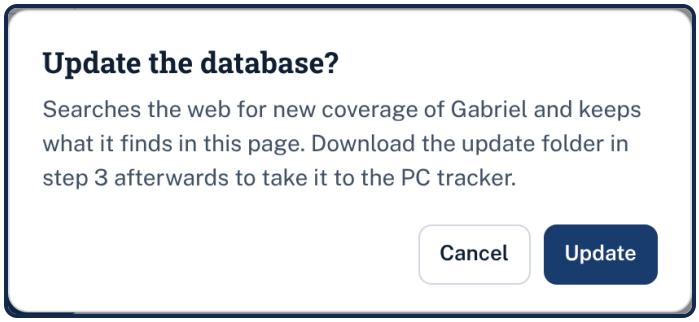
IN THE STATION · STEP 2

Press Update database

1. In **Step 2: Update**, press **Update database**. It starts at once. (The **Update database** button at the top of the page first asks “Update the database?”; press **Update** in that box.)
2. **Keep the tab open** and in front until it finishes. It takes about 25 minutes. Browsers slow down tabs in the background, which can stall the run. You can use other programs; just don’t close the tab.
3. Watch the checklist. Each line gets a check mark when it is done: search the web, add new stories, translate non-English stories, keep them for the update folder. While it runs, a **Stop** button under the checklist ends the run early.



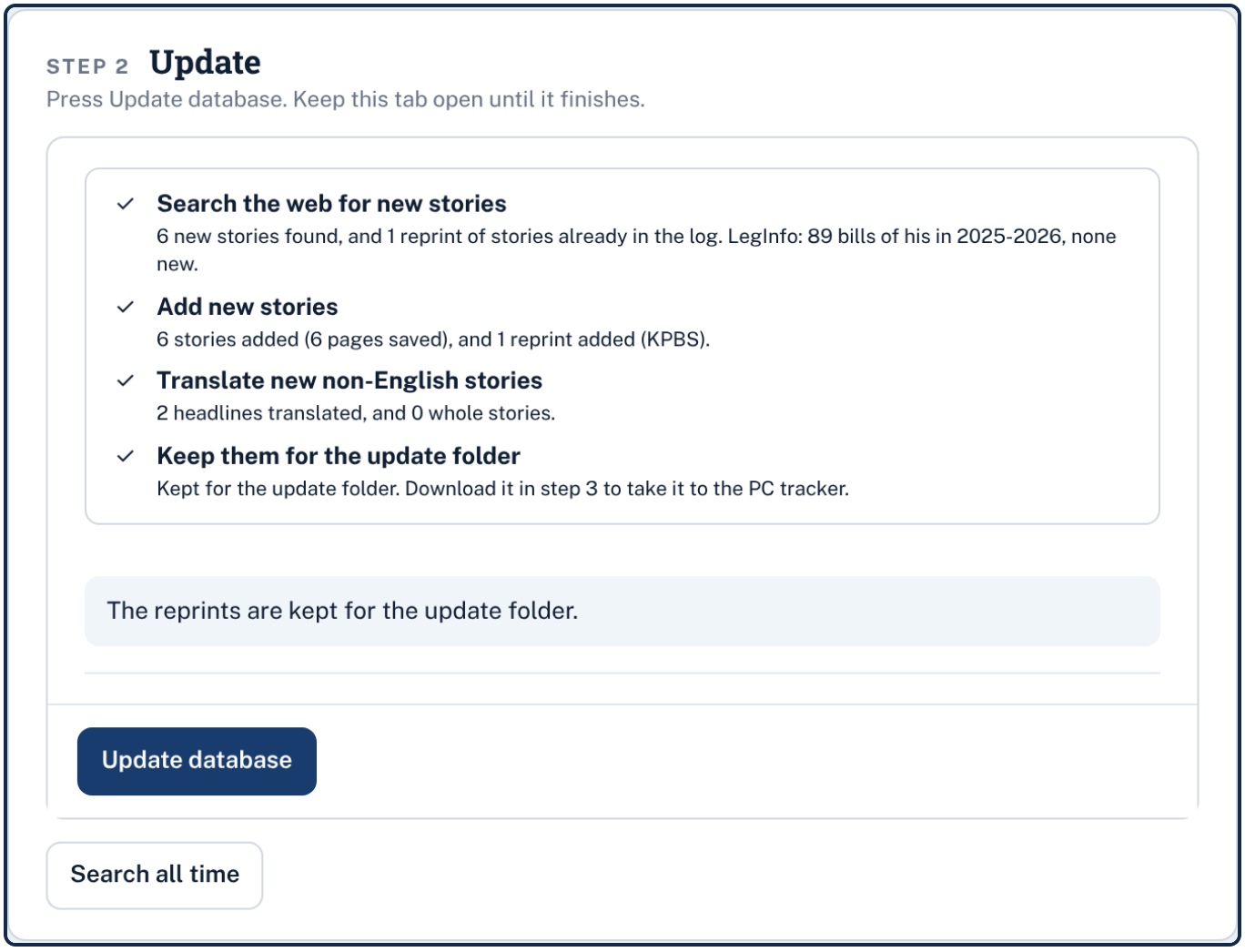
While it runs: the line in blue is the one being worked on. Stop ends the run early. Search all time is grayed out until the run is over.



The confirm box that the button at the top of the page shows.

STEP 2, CONTINUED

When the run is done



A finished run (example numbers). Each line says what it found. The line below the checklist says what happens to the rest.

What the search does for you

- Claude, the AI, reads every result and keeps only real news stories that name Assemblymember Gabriel. It leaves out press releases, social posts, YouTube, blogs, listing pages, music and board pages, and other people named Gabriel.
- It fills in each story's issue, bills, format, reach and tone.
- **A story the tracker already has is left out**, even when the tracker's copy came from NewsBank and has no web link.
- **A copy of a known story at another outlet is added as a reprint** of it.
- Old reprints with no date are left out. A row with no date takes the date in its web address when it has one.

- Stories not in English get an English headline now. The whole story is translated into English when you download the folder (page 12).

IF A NEWSBANK REFRESH IS DUE

One short line appears in Step 2: “A NewsBank refresh is due: add new NewsBank PDFs below.” It is only a reminder. See page 11.

IF THE RUN ENDS EARLY

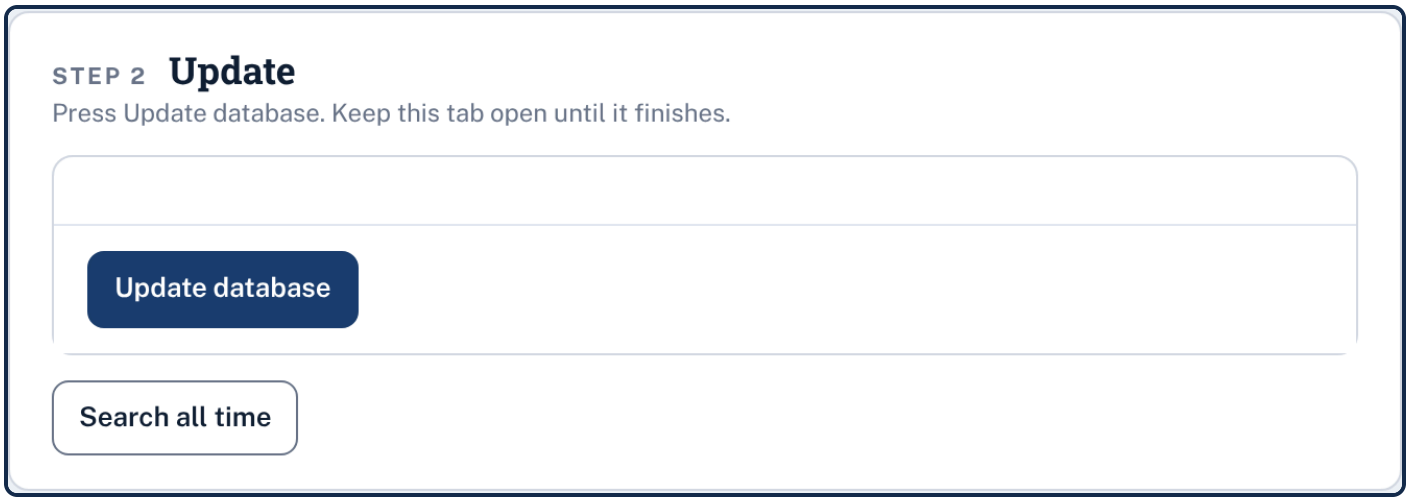
A red note says so. It does not mean “nothing new”. Press Update database again, or download what it found and run it again another time.

STEP 2, OPTIONAL

Search all time

The normal Update looks only at the weeks since the newest story. **Search all time**, under the Update database button, runs the same searches **with no date limit**. Use it now and then to catch older stories the tracker never had. It takes longer and uses more searches. Stories the tracker already has are left out, as always.

1. Press **Search all time**. The button changes to “Search all time: press again to start”.
2. Press it **again** within a few seconds to start. If you wait, it goes back to normal and nothing starts. This is so it isn’t started by accident.
3. Keep the tab open until it finishes, as with a normal Update. Its results go into the same Step 3 folder.
4. Afterwards the button turns itself off. The next Update database is a normal one again.



After the first press: press again to start.

IN THE STATION · OPTIONAL

Add NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs

About 1 in 6 stories (print, wire stories, paywalled papers) can't be found on the web. About once a month, and soon after big events like the budget vote, add them from NewsBank. ProQuest PDFs work the same way in their own box.

1. **Download the PDFs** by following the **NewsBank Download Guide** (a separate printed guide): the State Library sign-in, the saved search, Sort by Oldest, and one PDF per page of results with APA citations. It says to start one week before the newest story in the tracker; the station shows that date in Step 1 as **Newest story**.
2. **Drop the PDFs** on the box **Add NewsBank PDFs and newspaper pages** (or **Add ProQuest PDFs**). You can drop many at once. A PDF can hold any number of stories.
3. With **Automatic mode** on (in Step 3 on the page; on by default), they are added by themselves. If it is off, check the list and press **Add to the update**.



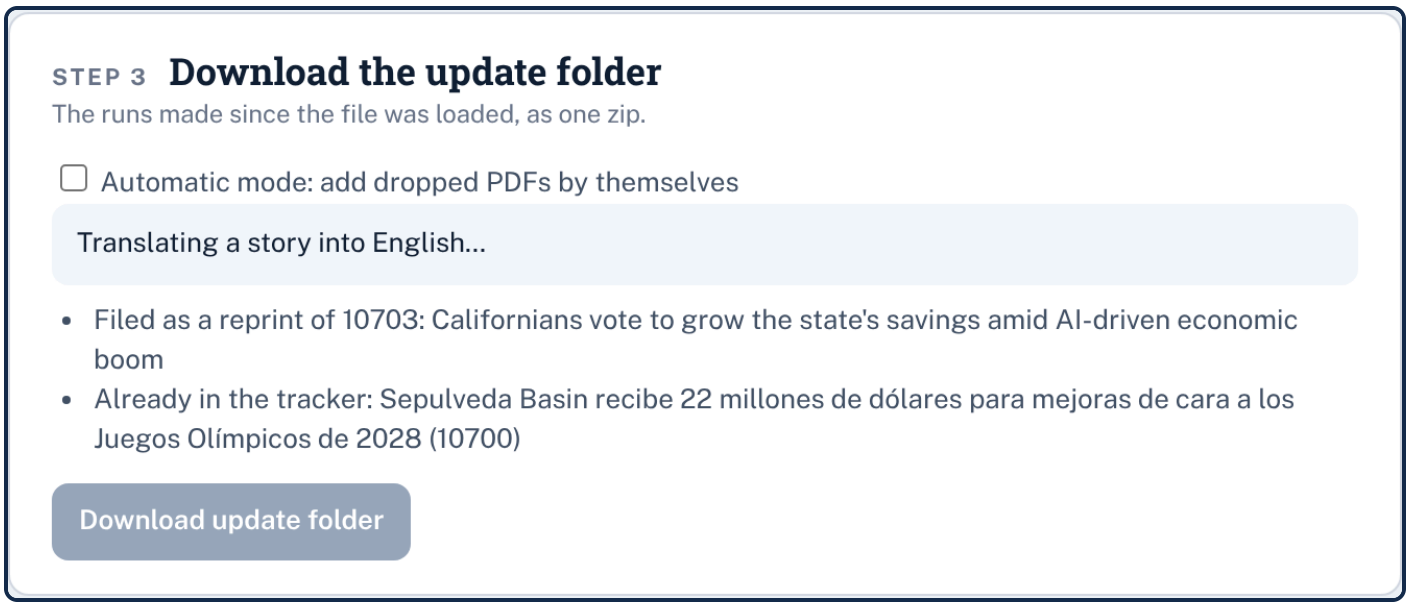
The NewsBank box. It also takes a picture or PDF of any newspaper page. "Add to the update" wakes up once a PDF is dropped. The ProQuest box below it looks the same.

- The station splits each NewsBank PDF into one PDF per story and skips stories the tracker already has.
- A NewsBank "Full Page" is a picture of a newspaper page. Claude reads it and adds the article about him to the right story, or as a new story. A page it can't place goes to the workbook's **Unlinked print pages** tab.
- If a run is going, the PDFs wait for it to finish.

IN THE STATION · STEP 3

Download the update folder

1. When the run (and any PDFs) are done, **Step 3** says what is ready, for example “Ready: 1 run: 6 new stories, 1 reprint”. Lines such as “Filed as a reprint of 10703: …” name finds the station filed under a story the tracker already has (10703 is that story’s Article ID). “Already in the tracker: …” names a find it left out.
2. Press **Download update folder**.
3. **Wait.** If there are stories in other languages, the status line first says “Translating story 1 of 2 into English…” (or “Translating a story into English…” for one). Each one gets a full English translation. This can take a few minutes. Then the folder is made and downloads.
4. It saves one .zip to your Downloads folder, named like `ajg_update_20261105-2021_83614b19.zip` (the date and time, then the workbook’s fingerprint). If your browser asks, confirm the save. Afterwards Step 3 says the folder was downloaded and offers **Download the last one again**, in case the file went missing.
5. If you add more after downloading, download again. The new folder has everything and replaces the old one; its name ends in `_v2`. Bring in only the newest one.
6. **Don’t unzip it.** The PC tracker takes the .zip file itself. If the station ran on another computer, copy the .zip back to the office PC now.

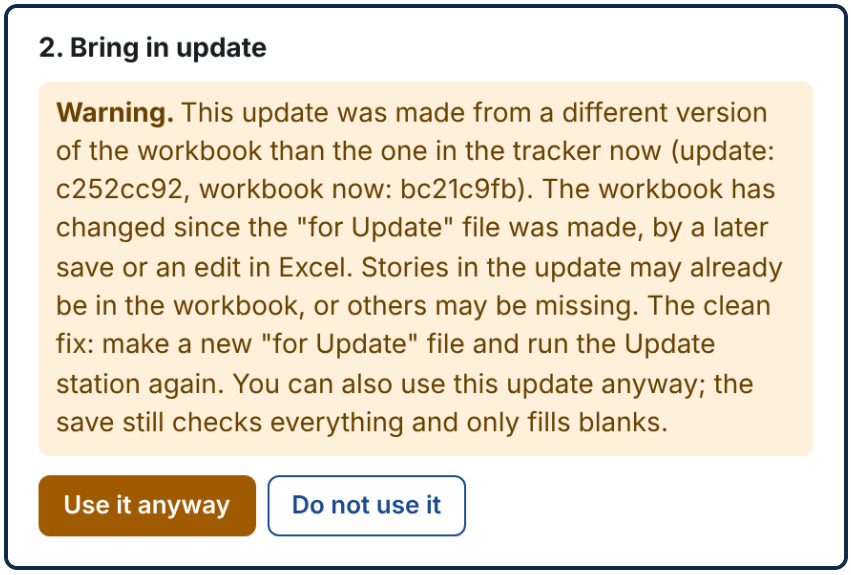


While a non-English story is translated. The button stays grayed out until the folder is made.

ON THE PC

Bring in the update

1. Close Excel. In the tracker, click **Tracker files**.
2. Drop the update zip on the dashed box under **2. Bring in update**, or click **choose a file**.
3. Wait. The tracker checks the update. Nothing is saved yet. It can take a few minutes.
4. **If a yellow warning appears**, the workbook changed after you made the “for Update” file. Press **Use it anyway** to go on to the preview (the save still checks everything and only fills blanks), or **Do not use it** to stop. The clean fix is a new “for Update” file and a new station run.
5. Read the preview (next page), then press **Save** at its end, or **Do not use this update**.



The warning for an update made from an older workbook: Use it anyway, or Do not use it.

Read the preview

2. Bring in update

If you press Save: 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

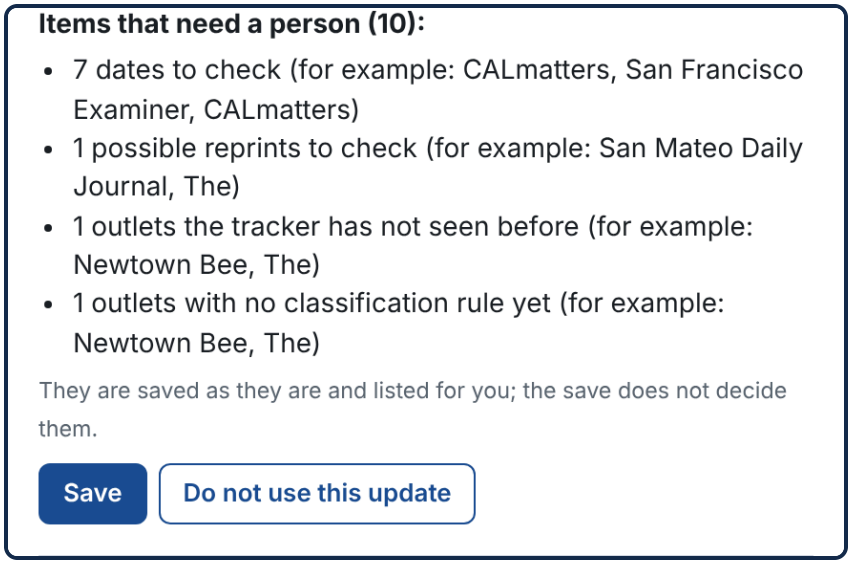
You chose to use an update made from an older workbook. The save still runs all its checks.

- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1 story removed (s01888)
- 21 rows added to the Coverage tab
- 10 rows added to the Originals tab
- 1 row added to the Removed tab
- 2 rows added to the Unlinked print pages tab
- 4 reprint counts updated
- 2 cells of removed stories' rows moved to the Removed tab
- 2 press-release cells recalculated
- 25 saved pages added to the library
- 1 file of removed stories moved aside (not deleted)

The top of the preview: what Save would do. (A long list of renamed files under it is left out here.)

- **The bold line** sums up what Save would do: rows added, cells filled, reprints, and your own waiting edits.
- The tracker compares the article texts to make the final call on what is a reprint, and gives the new files their final numbers. The preview lists every change.
- “Conflicts left for the keeper to decide” means cells where the update and the workbook disagree; the save kept the workbook’s value and left them for the keeper.

Items that need a person, then Save



The end of the preview: items that need a person, then Save.

Items that need a person are things the save does not decide for you. **The save writes them as they are** and lists them. Each line names the kind of item, with examples:

Item	What it means
Cells where the update disagrees with the workbook	The update had a different value; the workbook kept its own.
Dates to check	The save could not confirm the story's date. Check it against the story.
Possible reprints to check	The story may be a copy of one the tracker already has.
Outlets not seen before / with no classification rule	A new outlet; its reach and type may need setting.
Other kinds	The line says in plain words what it is, for example stories where it is unclear they are about the Assemblymember.

Nothing needs doing before you press Save. Afterwards, check those rows in the workbook. If a filled value is wrong, the keeper fixes it in Excel and then uses Tracker files, Repairs, "Accept the workbook as it is now".

1. Press **Save**, or **Do not use this update** to drop it.
2. Keep the black window open. The tracker backs up the workbook, writes, then reloads the page by itself.

ON THE PC, CONTINUED

After the save

2. Bring in update

Saved. 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

- Backup of the old workbook: AJG Coverage - NewsBank BACKUP before run run-mw3o2qv2rzz 2026-11-05 1213.xlsx

After Save: the result and the backup it made.

- 0 file name(s) were as the station named them.
- 1 edit saved and set aside in the tracker (db_applied\edits, not deleted)
- New workbook fingerprint: 41315fe0
- The tracker page was rebuilt with the new stories
- 10 items are listed for a person to look at (see the run notes)

Reloading the tracker...

The end of the result: the new workbook fingerprint. (“db_applied\edits” is a folder inside data; you never need to open it.)

The new stories are now in the tracker. The line at the top of the page says “Last updated” with today’s date, and the Update log in Manage lists the update with everything it added.

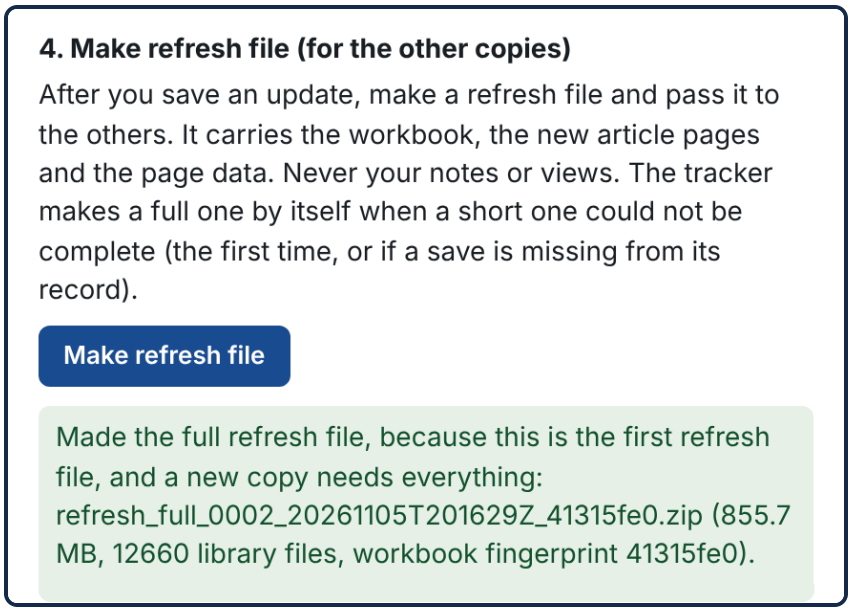
NEXT TIME, A NEW “FOR UPDATE” FILE

The save changed the workbook. Before the next station run, make a new “for Update” file.

ON THE PC

Make refresh files for colleagues

1. In **Tracker files**, under **4. Make refresh file**, click **Make refresh file**.
2. It downloads to your Downloads folder.
3. Pass it on by the **shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick**. Don’t use email or Teams: the first refresh file carries the whole library and is hundreds of MB; later ones are smaller.
4. Each colleague closes Excel, opens their own tracker, clicks **Tracker files**, and drops the file on **Bring in refresh file**. Their notes and saved views stay as they are.



The refresh file was made: 855.7 MB, because it was the first one. Under this message the tracker also says where a copy is kept (data\refresh_out) and to pass the file on by the shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick; it can be too big for email or Teams.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Problems and fixes

What you see	What to do
On the office PC, the station page will not open (or stays blank)	Office PCs block the address these pages run from, and IT has been asked to allow it. Until then run the station on another computer (for example a Mac): copy the “for Update” file to it, run the station there, and copy the update folder (.zip) back to the office PC. Do not try to get around the block.
The station page asks you to sign in	Sign in to claude.ai with the office account; the keeper has it.
“Claude is not allowed on this page”	Allow Claude for the station page in the Permissions menu, including sending pictures, then reload the page.
The search finds nothing or stops at once	TinyFish must be connected in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors) and allowed for the station page.
“File made … Saved in the tracker since then? Make a new file first.”	It is a reminder, not an error. If you saved in the tracker after making the file, make a new “for Update” file and load that one. Otherwise the update finds that save’s stories again.
Stories you already saved show up again in the preview	The “for Update” file was made before that save. Make a new file, load it, and run the station again.
“Search all time” did nothing	It needs a second press within a few seconds of the first (the button says “press again to start”). It is grayed out while a run is going.
“A NewsBank refresh is due”	A reminder only. Add new NewsBank PDFs when you can (page 11). Nothing is blocked.
Download seems stuck on “Translating story … into English…”	It is translating the whole story, one at a time. Wait; keep the tab open. If one can’t be translated, the folder still downloads, and a line under the button says which story keeps only its English headline and summary.
A red note says the run ended early	It does not mean nothing new. Run Update database again.
You closed the station tab during a run	The run stops. Load the “for Update” file again and press Update database again.
You added PDFs after downloading	Download again. Bring in only the newest zip (the one ending _v2, _v3 …).
The PC warns the update was made from a different workbook	Make a new “for Update” file and run the station again, or press Use it anyway.

What you see	What to do
The PC says the update was already saved	You brought in a zip that was saved before. Nothing is added twice. Use the newest zip, or make a new “for Update” file and run again.
Save is grayed out	Close Excel, and wait for any other save to finish. If the workbook was changed in Excel, use Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”.
“That is not a .zip file”	Drop the .zip itself, not an unzipped folder.

CHEAT SHEET

Start to finish

On the PC

1. Tracker files → **Make “for Update” file**; copy it to the station’s computer (p. 4).
2. When the zip is downloaded: Tracker files → **Bring in update** → drop the zip (p. 13).
3. Read the preview and the items that need a person → **Save**.
4. **Make refresh file** → shared drive, OneDrive or USB (p. 17).

In the Update station (its Steps 1–3)

1. Step 1: drop the “for Update” file; check **Newest story** and **Update searches from** (p. 5).
2. Step 2: **Update database**. Keep the tab open, about 25 minutes (p. 8). **Search all time** (press twice) now and then (p. 10).
3. Also, optional: drop NewsBank / ProQuest PDFs (p. 11).
4. Step 3: **Download update folder**; wait for any translations; copy the .zip to the office PC (p. 12).

REMEMBER

Make a new “for Update” file after every save. The office PC can’t open the station yet: use another computer for it. Bring in only the newest zip. Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC.